

BARCLAYS

Barclays is a British multinational bank headquartered in London, founded in 1690. It is one of the UK's "Big Four" banks and operates in over 40 countries with 80,000 employees. Barclays has two main divisions: Barclays UK (retail and business banking) and Barclays International (investment banking, corporate banking, and wealth management). It is known for innovations like introducing the world's first ATM (1967) and has a strong global presence, especially in the US and India. While it has faced controversies like the LIBOR scandal, it remains a major player in finance, offering careers in banking, technology, and investment services.

The selection process consisted of **3 rounds**:

- 1) Online Assessment
 - 2) Technical Interview
 - 3) HR Interview
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1. Online Assessment (Virtual – 70 minutes)

- The test had **25 questions** in total: **20 MCQs** and **5 SQL queries**.
 - **MCQs** were focused on OOP concepts, debugging, and output prediction of C/C++/Java codes.
 - **SQL queries** covered basics such as string operations, arithmetic operations, aggregate functions, and queries involving date and time extraction.
 - The assessment was conducted on the **HackerEarth** platform.
 - Out of 200 students, **46 were shortlisted** for the interview.
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2. Technical Interview (@CUIC)

- The interviewer primarily assessed knowledge of **Data Structures, OOP, and DBMS**.
- My interview lasted **1 hour 20 minutes**. The more confidently and clearly you answer, the more engaged the interviewer becomes.
- **Resume and self-introduction** played a major role. Ensure your resume only contains skills and experiences you are comfortable discussing.

- I was asked about my **responsibilities, certifications**, and highlighted that I had solved **300+ LeetCode problems** focused on data structures, which impressed the interviewer.
- My **projects** were discussed in detail. The interviewer checked for real involvement, asking about technologies used, risks faced, and team management in my startup idea.
- I was asked to explain the **steps involved from clicking a URL to rendering a webpage** (basic networking knowledge).
- I was asked to share a challenging problem which took a lot of time to figure out the concepts .I shared the Seven Bridges of Königsberg algorithm from LeetCode—which sparked interest.
- I was also asked to suggest features for a **photo gallery app** and explain which **data structure** I would use and why. I compared **Linked List** and **TreeMap** for the solution.
- At the end, I asked the recruiter about **their expectations from interns**, which left a positive impression.
- From this round, **25 students advanced** to the HR interview.

3. HR Interview (@CUIC)

- This round focused on **confidence, mindset, and alignment with core values of Barclays (RISES: Respect, Integrity, Service, Excellence, Stewardship)**.
- I was asked **five scenario-based questions** related to these values:
 1. You are working on project which mislead from the path , how would you react to this and what will be your solution?
 2. How will you assist your team with the your potential impact on the project or some feature you are working on?
 3. How will you ensure the idea you proposed reaches the user who could be an individual or the group of peoples?
 4. How would you ensure continuous improvement in your product, even without your direct involvement?
 5. How would you handle a situation where a teammate disagrees with you?
- This round lasted about **30 minutes**.

- Out of 25 students, **15 were selected** for the **Barclays 2026 Summer Internship Programme**, including **5 from our CSE department**—and I was one of them.

Tips for Future Candidates

- Be **careful and accurate** in every stage, including test registration and resume preparation.
- For **DBMS-related questions**, start with an **ER diagram**, then explain the schema and write queries.
- Be thorough with **DBMS concepts**: normalization, ER diagrams, keys, and SQL fundamentals.
- Keep your resume concise and ensure you can confidently answer **any question based on it**.
- Maintain a **CGPA of at least 8.0+** (8.5+ is ideal) to secure eligibility for the online assessment.
- Be **confident, clear, and engaging** in your answers to keep the recruiter interested.
- Remember, your **resume and projects are the backbone** of your interview performance.
- Be confident with your answers and try to give your best in every answer.

Wishing you the very best in all your future endeavors

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